

PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA

Web Page: www.stteresasparish.church stteresas@downandconnor.org

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 g.lyons@downandconnor.org

Parish Office open Tuesday, Wednesday & Thursday 9am to 3pm.

6 September 2026, Twenty Third Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A.

Sunday Gospel *In any group, small and big, things cause friction. Everyone thinks his or her way is right. We can fight over who is right. Some things are worth a fight, others not. In the big questions of life, we need the advice, support and love of the other. Many people ask themselves, "Why I didn't give an honest opinion about a decision like marriage or a job or a course of studies which seemed ill-advised to everyone?" We all have good and not-so-good tendencies. We can only advise as best we can, sensitively and wisely, and hope we get a hearing. We are afraid to hurt, to be rejected. Why do we let so many people drink themselves into trouble and never tell them? The terror of a neighbourhood, no matter what age, needs to be confronted. The problem of drugs in a neighbourhood is not confronted. Crime is not reported. In small and big things we are each others' keepers. Jesus is saying something like that today. Parents can find this difficult as they try to guide the family well and not lose them. We have social responsibility in the family and in the neighbourhood and even worldwide for the common good. (Fr D Neary)*

Please note, St Teresa's Church will be closed from Monday 7 September 2026 until Saturday 12 September 2026. It will take 5 days to repair the sanctuary steps that were vandalised in November 2025.

Sunday Masses Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil 5pm, St Matthias' 10am, St Teresa's 12noon.

Weekday Masses St Matthias Monday 7pm, Tuesday 10am, Wednesday 10am, Thursday 10am, Friday 7am & 10am, Saturday 10am.

Confessions Saturday 4 30pm in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.

Recently Deceased Martin McKenna, Andrew Campbell.

Months Mind Maureen McCrossan

Anniversaries, Mary McDermot, Desmond Nugent, Catherine Morrison, Sr Catherine O'Connor, Rosie Glover, Andrew Murray.

Monday Lunch Club will reopen on 7 September 2026 at 1.15pm. All welcome. Looking forward to seeing everyone.

Bible Study in St Mathias Conference Room, at the back of the church Tuesdays 7pm-8.30pm starting week 8 September 2026. All welcome. For details contact Jeanette 0751 8315970

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith. The 2025–2026 programme begins on Wednesday 1 October and runs weekly from 6.30–8pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions.



Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.

Stella Maris the Catholic seafaring and fishers' charity is looking for volunteers. This could be ship visiting, knitting woolly hats or arranging our Easter & Christmas appeals. It is to support our Belfast Chaplain, Brian Rances. For further information, please contact Peter at peter.mullen@stellamarismail.org or 07745543959.

A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee, speaker. For further information, contact Thomas 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Monday 14 September 2026 at 7.30pm in the Crowne Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. You do not need to register in advance. Call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

West Belfast Historical Society meeting on Friday the 11 September 2026 7.30pm in St Michael's Parish Centre. *The Lusitania and the U Boat Campaign 1914 -1918*. The guest speaker will be Michael McConway.

Lough Derg Day Retreat Saturday 19 September 2026. Leaving St Paul's at 6.30am returning to Paul's at 7.30pm. Includes bus, boat, tea & scones on arrival then a light lunch and retreat. Price £45 plus the bus price, determined on the uptake. Telephone St Paul's Parish Office on 028 90325034 Monday to Thursday.

St Vincent De Paul Helpline Phone no. 028 90351561: Email address: info@svpni.co.uk
Website address: www.svp.ie/get-help.aspx